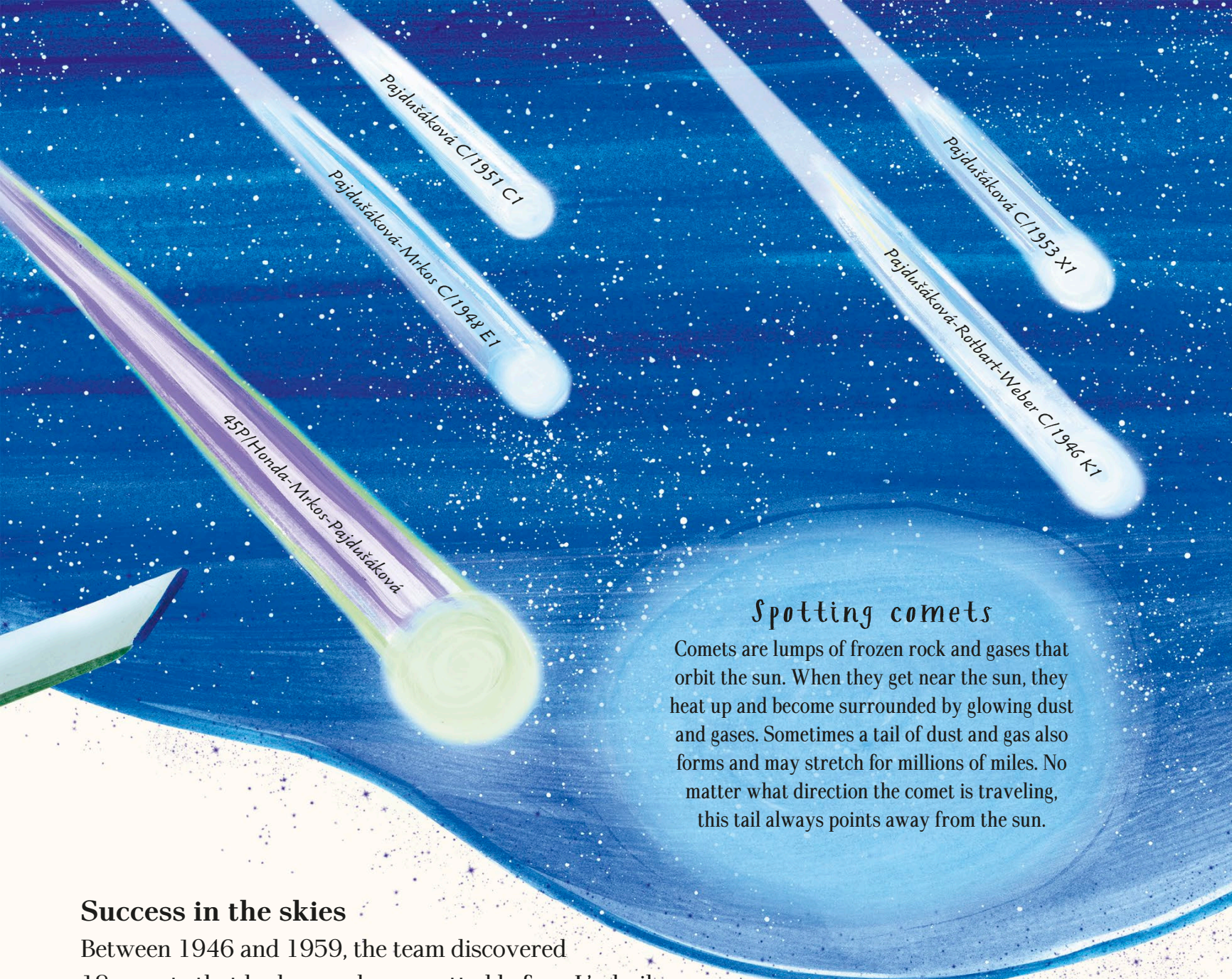




Spotting comets

Comets are lumps of frozen rock and gases that orbit the sun. When they get near the sun, they heat up and become surrounded by glowing dust and gases. Sometimes a tail of dust and gas also forms and may stretch for millions of miles. No matter what direction the comet is traveling, this tail always points away from the sun.

Success in the skies

Between 1946 and 1959, the team discovered 18 comets that had never been spotted before. L'udmila found five of these herself and became famous! In 1958, she was made director of the Skalná Pleso Observatory and Astronomical Institute, in the Tatra Mountains in modern-day Slovakia. For the next 20 years, L'udmila researched different areas of space. She taught young people about astronomy and joined councils and committees to encourage other women in Europe to become astronomers.

The asteroid 3636 Pajdušáková is named in L'udmila's honor.

L'udmila became an expert in the sun and its corona (atmosphere), which could be photographed by blocking out the sun itself. Never try to photograph the sun yourself, as this would damage your eyes and could cause blindness.

